

Valeria Portas

140 Meadowwood Ln, Madison Township, PA 18444 | valeriamufuni@gmail.com | 917-607-3749

Work Experience

NeuroFlow

Philadelphia, PA

Senior UX Researcher/Designer (Remote)

12/2021 - 11/2023

- Designed and implemented the company's first UX research workflow and centralized research repository, improving the organization of the research process and insights accessibility for cross-functional teams.
- Led UX research projects across up to 5 parallel initiatives, including accessibility and human-factors.
- Partnered with product managers and clinical stakeholders to integrate research practices into the roadmap.
- Mentored and supervised in-house associates and contractors, equipping them with new research skills.
- Managed participant recruitment and expanded the research database to enable qualitative and quantitative research, integrating AI-assisted tools to enhance recruitment efficiency and participant engagement.
- Designed and facilitated tailored research workshops with product managers and design team, synthesizing findings into actionable recommendations that aligned cross-functional teams around product decisions.
- Worked directly with the company's clients on survey designs and analysis together with Customer Success, providing insights that improved user understanding and supported renewal of 5 enterprise contracts.
- Used SQL, Metabase, and Mixpanel to extract and analyze data supporting research and recruitment.

RSM (Client: Discover Financial Services)

New York, NY

UX Researcher (Contract)

07/2022 - 08/2022

- Partnered with RSM project team to identify improvement opportunities, establish priority criteria for white-boarding session-based solutions, and define next steps for Discover data analytics and audit teams.
- Conducted interviews with 5 employees from both teams to identify their current state of work process flows and its weaknesses, and factors contributing to slow data processing and audit quality issues.
- Assisted with preparation and facilitation of white-boarding session for teams' work optimization strategies.
- Created branded user personas for 6 persona types and user journeys for workflows of the two teams.

Product Research & Design

New York, NY

UX Research & Design Consultant (Freelance)

12/2020 - 12/2021

- Planned and conducted primary and secondary UX research at various stages of product development. Identified target user groups and created user flows, brand guidelines, and features that address users' needs.
- Created wireframes and low-fidelity prototypes in Figma to communicate design ideas effectively.

Project Experience - Lando's (liquor stores and delivery). Role – UX & UI support.

- Planned and conducted competitors research, feature comparison, user interviews and usability studies.
- Created user flows, wireframes and prototypes in Figma based on results of UX research.
- Effectively communicated complex design requirements to engineers; worked with illustrators on various logo design ideas. Collaborated with CTO and owner on budget planning and project milestones.

Columbia Business School (BRL)

New York, NY

Senior Behavioral Research Assistant (part-time)

09/2018 - 05/2021

- Supported end-to-end behavioral research projects, learning about the product development process and B2B experience. Results were used for more than 20 research projects on human behavior.

Relevant Skills

Software skills: R, Python, SQL, Qualtrics, Survey Monkey, Figma, FigJam, Mixpanel, Lookback

Research skills + AI: Claude, ChatGPT, Notion AI, Google Stitch, Pencil, Usability Studies, Card Sorting, User Interviews, User Personas, Journey Maps, Diary Studies, Guerilla Testing, Surveys, Heuristic Evaluation

Languages: Fluent English, Native Russian, Native Ukrainian

Education

Columbia University; School of General Studies, New York, NY

Double BA in Experimental Psychology and Research, Political Science and Government